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# Brain tumor detection and multi-classification using advanced deep learning techniques

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## Abstract

A brain tumor is an uncontrolled development of brain cells in brain cancer if not detected at an early stage. Early brain tumor diagnosis plays a crucial role in treatment planning and patients' survival rate. There are distinct forms, properties, and therapies of brain tumors. Therefore, manual brain tumor detection is complicated, time-consuming, and vulnerable to error. Hence, automated computer-assisted diagnosis at high precision is currently in demand. This article presents segmentation through Unet architecture with ResNet50 as a backbone on the Figshare data set and achieved a level of 0.9504 of the intersection over union (IoU). The preprocessing and data augmentation concept were introduced to enhance the classification rate. The multi-classification of brain tumors is performed using evolutionary algorithms and reinforcement learning through transfer learning. Other deep learning methods such as ResNet50, DenseNet201, MobileNet V2, and InceptionV3 are also applied. Results thus obtained exhibited that the proposed research framework performed better than reported in state of the art. Different CNN, models applied for tumor classification such as MobileNet V2, Inception V3, ResNet50, DenseNet201, NASNet and attained accuracy 91.8, 92.8, 92.9, 93.1, 99.6%, respectively. However, NASNet exhibited the highest accuracy.

Two processes of transfer learning: freeze and fine-tune, are performed to extract significant features from MRI slices. Brain tumor multi-classification is performed using transfer learning, ResNet50-UNet, and NASNet architecture.

## KEYWORDS

brain tumor, cancer, health risks, healthcare, NASNet, WHO

## 1 | INTRODUCTION

Analysis and classification of medical imaging play an important role in detecting abnormalities in various body organs, such as blood cancer (Abbas, Saba, Mohamad, et al., 2018; Abbas, Saba, Rehman, et al., 2019; Abbas, Saba, Rehman, et al., 2019; Abbas, Saba, Mehmood, et al., 2019; Rehman, Abbas, Saba, Mahmood, & Kolivand, 2018; Rehman, Abbas, Saba, Rahman, et al., 2018; Rehman, Abbas, Saba, Mehmood, et al., 2018), lung cancer (Khan, Nazir,

et al., 2019; Saba, 2019; Saba, 2020; Saba, Sameh, Khan, Shad, & Sharif, 2019), brain tumor (Saba, Mohamed, El-Affendi, Amin, & Sharif, 2020), breast cancer (Marie-Sainte, Saba, Alsaleh, Alotaibi, & Bin, 2019; Mughal, Muhammad, Sharif, Rehman, & Saba, 2018; Mughal, Muhammad, Sharif, Saba, & Rehman, 2017; Mughal, Sharif, Muhammad, & Saba, 2018). Moreover, organ abnormalities often lead to rapid growth of tumors, which is the world's leading cause of death (Fahad, Khan, Saba, Rehman, & Iqbal, 2018; Saba, Al-Zahrani, & Rehman, 2012; Saba, Bokhari, Sharif, Yasmin, & Raza, 2018; Saba,

Rehman, Mehmood, Kolivand, & Sharif, 2018; Ullah et al., 2019; Yousaf, Mehmood, Saba, et al., 2019; Yousaf, Mehmood, Awan, et al., 2019).

Brain tumors are a deadly illness and are blamed for several deaths worldwide per year (Amin, Sharif, et al., 2020; Amin, Sharif, Raza, Saba, & Anjum, 2019; Amin, Sharif, Raza, Saba, & Rehman, 2019; Amin, Sharif, Rehman, Raza, & Mufti, 2018; Amin, Sharif, Yasmin, Saba, & Raza, 2019). Brain tumor appears in two kinds: benign and malignant. The benign tumor does not migrate to the surrounding tissues, but it is typically not life threatening. Malignant tumor, however, extends to other tissues and is thus harmful (WHO). WHO classifies brain tumors into four groups (I, II, III, and IV). The least of all classes is the pace at which the Grade I tumor spreads itself, while the Grade IV tumor is the most harmful and destructive (Ejaz et al., 2018, 2020; Ejaz, Rahim, Bajwa, Rana, & Rehman, 2019). For patients' clinical preparation, early identification of brain tumors is very critical (Iqbal et al., 2019; Iqbal, Ghani, Saba, & Rehman, 2018; Iqbal, Khan, Saba, & Rehman, 2017). It is possible to detect brain tumors either through diagnostic image processing or through biopsy. Per strategy has its own pros and cons. Practitioners often utilize both invasive and non-invasive brain tumor diagnostic methods depending on the case (Saba et al., 2020).

Various experimental imaging techniques, including CT and MRI, are used for cancer/ tumor diagnosis. However, relative to CT, MRI is safer because it does not subject living cells to toxic radiation (Afza, Khan, Sharif, & Rehman, 2019; Al-Ameen et al., 2015; Husham, Alkawaz, Saba, Rehman, & Alghamdi, 2016; Hussain et al., 2020; Javed, Rahim, & Saba, 2019; Javed, Rahim, Saba, & Rashid, 2019; Javed, Rahim, Saba, & Rehman, 2020; Javed, Saba, Shafry, & Rahim, 2020). Normally, patients perform a biopsy to assess the tumor's form and classification following early detection of abnormality using brain MRI. In this respect, the biopsy findings for detecting brain tumors are regarded as an absolute test. Different computer-aided diagnostic solutions have been suggested to increase brain tumor diagnosis precision, whether benign or malignant. For the classification of brain tumor grade, different researchers have used a range of unsupervised learning methods such as SVM, logistic regression, K-means, and supervised learning such as random forest classifier, artificial neural networks, and naïve Bayes. Some researchers also proposed a hybrid classification for the same task (Adeel et al., 2020; Iftikhar, Fatima, Rehman, Almazyad, & Saba, 2017; Jamal, Hazim Alkawaz, Rehman, & Saba, 2017; Khan, Sharif, et al., 2020; Khan, Akram, et al., 2020; Khan, Sharif, Yasmin, & Saba, 2017; Saba, 2017).

Currently, deep learning has outperformed conventional machine learning methods in several functions in recent years. Several deep learning approaches have also been used (Mittal et al., 2020; Qureshi, Khan, Sharif, Saba, & Ma, 2020; Ramzan, Khan, et al., 2020; Ramzan, Khan, Iqbal, Saba, & Rehman, 2020). For the role of brain tumor grade classification, several researchers have used pre-trained CNN architectures and fine-tuned them. Some have recommended modern architectures as well and taught them from scratch. 2D was the bulk of the CNNs used, although others have even used CNN architectures in 3D (Khan, Sharif, et al., 2019; Khan, Javed, Sharif, Saba, & Rehman, 2019; Rehman, Khan, Saba, et al., 2021).

The brain tumor classification task generally consists of four phases: preprocessing, tumor detection, features extraction & selection, classification of brain tumor grade (Khan, Lali, et al., 2019).

A novel Fidon et al. have proposed scalable multimodal deep learning architecture for brain tumor detection (2017) with dice scores of 0.77, 0.64, and 0.56 on BraTS 2013 data set. Seetha and Raja (2018) introduced a CNN framework for automatic brain tumor identification and detection. For brain tumor segmentation and texture, Fuzzy-C-means creates features isolated from segmented areas. Finally, these features are fed to fused DNN and SVM classifiers and have reached 97.5% accuracy. Khawaldeh et al. introduced a non-invasive graduation scheme of brain Glioma tumors (2018) using an updated version of AlexNet CNN. The regression was achieved for whole-brain MR images and image labeling was not pixel level, but with the image level. The experimental results show that a reasonable performance was achieved by 91.16% of the method. Sajjad et al. (2019) proposed a comprehensive method for brain tumor gradings. For this reason, the tumorous region after data augmentation was fed to pre-trained VGG-19 CNN. The rating accuracy 87.38 and 90.67%, respectively, stated for data before and after the augmentation. Özyurt, Sert, Avci, and Dogantekin (2019) fused CNN with the neuromorphic, optimistic entropy of the total fuzzy expert (NS-CNN) to evaluate brain tumors. These images were then applied to the CNN for feature extraction. Eventually, extracted features are fed in the SVM classification to be categorized as benign or malignant with an averaged 95.62% precision.

For brain tumor grading classification, Saba, Mohamed, et al. (2020) used the GrabCut technique to obtain MRI texture characteristics. Of note, 98.78, 99.63, and 99.67% accuracy recorded on (BraTS) of VGG-19 (CNN architecture) in 2015, 2016, and 2017, respectively. Ejaz et al. (2020) proposed using the MICCAI BraTS data set for hybrid SOM pixel marking with decreased cluster inclusion and deterministic function clustering to identify brain tumors. The cluster was collected utilizing three unsupervised learning methods for brain tumor segmentation. The system was tested using the dice overlap test, the Jaccard Tanimoto coefficient test, mean squared error, and peak signal to noise ratio. The findings obtained were 98%, 0.06, 18 lb, and 96%, respectively (Khan, Ashraf, et al., 2020).

Iqbal et al. (2019) have developed a deep learning model for brain tumor segmentation by combining short-term memory (LSTM) and coevolutionary neural networks (ConvNet). Of note, 75% ConvNet accuracy, 80% LSTM-based network accuracy, and 82.29% composite accuracy were recorded on the BraTS 2018 data set. Recently, for brain tumor detection, Rehman, Khan, Saba, et al. (2021) used pre-trained 3D CNN. Three BraTS databases were checked in 2015, 2017, and 2018, with 98.32, 96.97, and 92.67% precision.

## 1.1 | Main contributions

The main contributions of this research are as under

- In the preprocessing phase, a contrast-stretching algorithm is used to produce images of high-resolution.

- Brain tumor detection is performed through Unet architecture with ResNet50 as a backbone.
- The process of data augmentation is employed to achieve better results on small datasets.
- A new optimized framework called NASNet is applied, which uses the idea of Evolutionary Algorithms (EAs) and Reinforcement Learning (RL) for the optimization task.
- Finally, we also employed other deep transfer learning models such as ResNet50, DenseNet201, MobileNet V2 and InceptionV3 for brain tumor classification. We compared them with the NASNet Model to show the efficiency of NASNet model.

Further, this article is structured into different sections, Section 2 presents research background, Section 3 presents the proposed model with a detailed explanation of data set, preprocessing, ResNet50-UNet segmentation, NASNet model, data augmentation, and pseudo code. Section 4 highlighted the performance measures. Section 5 exhibits experimental results and Section 6 concludes research along with future directions.

## 2 | RESEARCH BACKGROUND

CNN has a prominent role in pattern and image recognition problems. CNN filters are convolved upon input image to extract features automatically. CNN architecture involves convolutional layers, pooling layers and fully connected layers and hidden layers based on architecture. The most common CNN architectures are AlexNet (Krizhevsky, Sutskever, & Hinton, 2012), VGGNet (Simonyan & Zisserman, 2015), MobileNet, DenseNet (DenseNet: Better CNN Model than ResNet, n. d.), Inception (Szegedy, Vanhoucke, Ioffe, Shlens, & Wojna, 2016), ResNet (He et al., 2016) and NASNet architecture (Radhika, Devika, Aswathi, & Padma, 2020). LeNet architecture introduced CNN's idea in 1990, but this architecture was not practical until 2010 due to limited computational resources. The notion of backpropagation was mainly presented by LeNet (LeCun, Bottou, Bengio, & Haffner, 1998). AlexNet was developed for object identification task and a deeper network than LeNet and it achieved better accuracy on ImageNet (Krizhevsky et al., 2012). Similarly, a filter size of  $3 \times 3$  was introduced in all the types of VGGNet, such as VGG16 and VGG19 to learn nonlinear, complex features and make it computationally efficient. Furthermore, GoogLeNet tried to reduce the number of parameters and computations (Szegedy et al., 2015). The main aim of all the grown architectures focused on increasing depth of the model to enhance accuracy. This causes a vanishing gradient problem; during back propagation, the gradient generates too small a value, resulting in poor learning. ResNet proposed a solution to the vanishing gradient problem by employing skip functions to enhance the network's performance. A dense network has been produced for pattern reuse (DenseNet: Better CNN Model than ResNet, n.d.). For successful employment in embedded and mobile applications, a separable-convolution was introduced to reduce the number of parameters in MobileNet (Sandler, Howard, Zhu, Zhmoginov, & Chen, 2018). A new

optimized framework called NASNet was evolved, which employed the idea of EAs and RL for optimization tasks (Zoph, Vasudevan, Shlens, & Le, 2018). Based on the information obtained from the above-stated frameworks, we focused on NASNet architecture. The proposed research work uses search techniques to locate good convolutional architectures on a database of interest. The search methodology employed in the NASNet model is the Neural Architecture Search (NAS) framework introduced by (Zoph & Le, 2017). We employed NASNet and various transfer learning techniques for useful feature extraction, including ResNet50, DenseNet201, MobileNet V2 and InceptionV3 to achieve classification and detection on target data set. Furthermore, we compared the NASNet model with others architecture to show its efficacy. Besides, we could use proposed methodology in other domains to gain the advantages of this research activity.

### 2.1 | Ethical approval

No experiments are conducted on animals and humans. Only publicly available benchmark data sets are used for experiments.

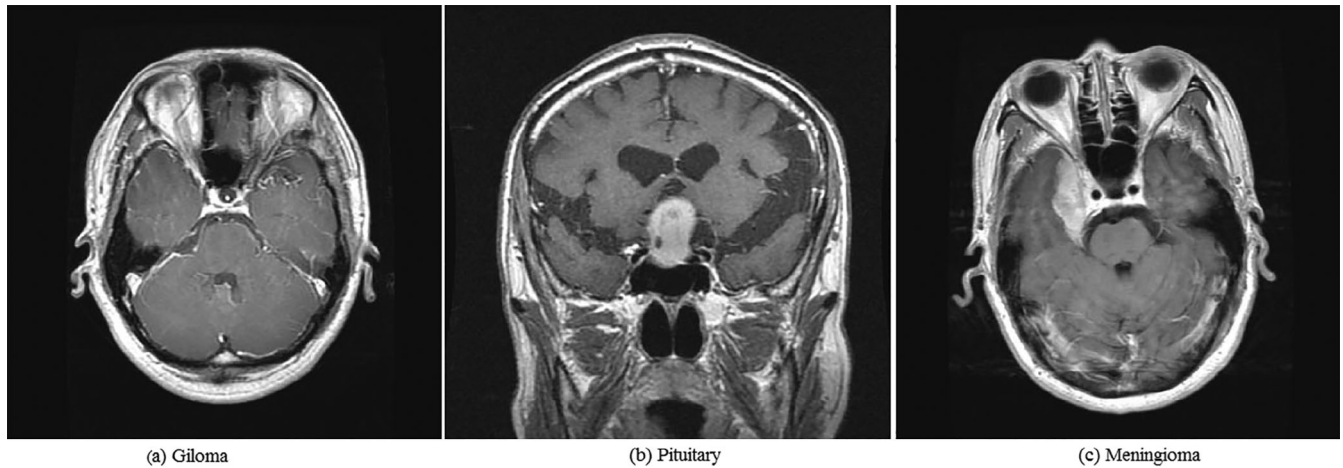
## 3 | PROPOSED MODEL FOR TUMOR DETECTION AND CLASSIFICATION

### 3.1 | Data sets

We employed a public brain tumor data set from Figshare source containing <sup>3,164</sup> brain MRI slices obtained from 233 patients (Cheng, 2017). It involves three brain tumors: glioma, pituitary, meningioma tumor and three distinct views: sagittal, axial, coronal views. The data set is available in ".mat" format. Each MAT-file covers a structure including patient ID,  $512 \times 512$  image data in uint16 format, types of brain tumors, border of tumor with the coordinate's points, and ground truth in binary mask image. As CNN architecture takes the image, we only used image data from the .mat files in our experiment as presented in Figure 1. Furthermore, database description is depicted in Table 1 and the distribution of tumor types is presented in Figure 2.

### 3.2 | Preprocessing

Normally preprocessing is employed to improve and enhance the input data to smooth line further processing (Lung, Salam, Rehman, Rahim, & Saba, 2014; Majid et al., 2020; Marie-Sainte, Aburahmah, Almohaini, & Saba, 2019; Marie-Sainte, Saba, et al., 2019; Rehman, Khan, Mehmood, et al., 2020). In this case, it was mandatory since the MRI images were acquired from various modalities that involve artifacts. Therefore, various image processing methodologies were employed to enhance its contrast (Saba, Khan, Islam, et al., 2019; Saba, Khan, Rehman, & Marie-Sainte, 2019; Sadad, Munir, Saba, &



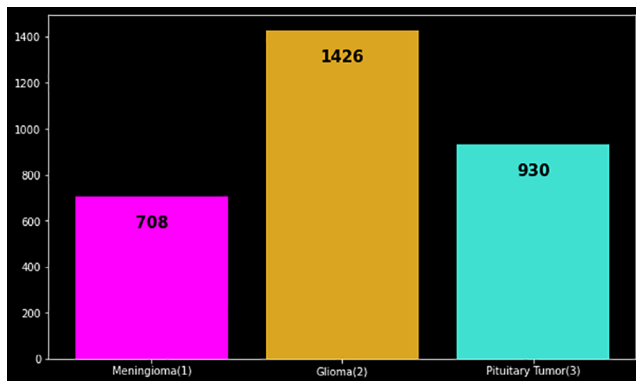
(a) Glioma

(b) Pituitary

(c) Meningioma

**FIGURE 1** Brain tumor types**TABLE 1** Dataset description

| Category   | Patients | Number of slice |
|------------|----------|-----------------|
| Glioma     | 91       | 1,426           |
| Pituitary  | 60       | 930             |
| Meningioma | 82       | 708             |
| Total      | 233      | 3,064           |

**FIGURE 2** Distribution of tumor type [Color figure can be viewed at wileyonlinelibrary.com]

Hussain, 2018). We applied the contrast-stretching algorithm to produce images of high-resolution using the following formula.

$$E(x, y) = \frac{i(x, y) - f_{\min}}{f_{\max} - f_{\min}}$$

where,  $f_{\min}$  and  $f_{\max}$  are the minimum [0] and maximum value [255] in the image  $i(x, y)$  and  $x, y$  denote each pixel in the image.

Furthermore, we resized the input images into  $224 \times 224$  as per the requirement of the proposed pre-trained models (Khan et al., 2019).

### 3.3 | Proposed model for brain tumor detection

In this article, we employed U-Net architecture (Ronneberger, Fischer, & Brox, 2015) for brain tumor detection, which achieved a remarkable efficiency in detecting medical images. The backbone applied is ResNet50 (He et al., 2016) which is pre-trained on the ImageNet data set. Thus, we employed Unet model with ResNet50 as a backbone to obtain the best detection. Our ResNet50-UNet segmentation architecture comprises an encoder and a decoder. The encoder is developed by eliminating the

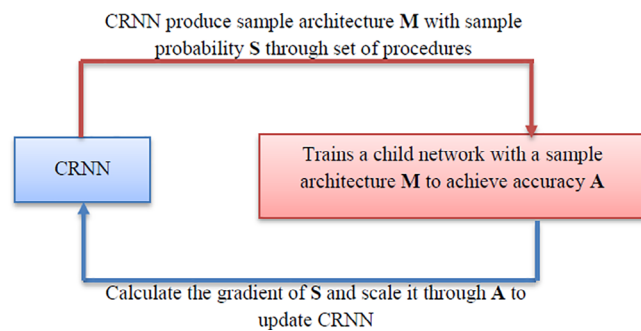
global average pooling and fully connected layer from the end of ResNet50. The decoder involves five blocks, every block containing  $2 \times 2$  up-sampling layer subsequently two sets of layers, encompassing a convolution layer, Rectified Linear Unit (ReLU) and batch normalization layer. The parameters are not set by the architecture itself and could be performed through a fine-tuning approach. The weights and learning rate of ResNet50-UNet architecture are loaded and initialized to train the model. Following parameters for ResNet50-UNet segmentation are set as illustrated in Table 2.

### 3.4 | Proposed model for brain tumor classification

The idea of NASNet model is introduced by the Google ML group based on reinforcement learning. In NASNet, various amendments are performed depending upon weights, the number of layers, regularization procedures, and so forth, to enhance the architecture's efficiency. The framework of NASNet comprises of CNN and Controller Recurrent Neural Network (CRNN) described in Figure 3. As shown, a CRNN samples child architectures with various networks. The child networks are trained to get accuracy. The obtained accuracies are employed for controller updating so that the controller will produce improved networks over time. The weights of the controller are updated through gradient policy. The NASNet frameworks select the finest best cells through the reinforcement learning approach, as explained in (Zoph et al., 2018). Chen et al. (2018) documented that a

**TABLE 2** Hyper-parameter for detection

|             |                  |
|-------------|------------------|
| Model       | Unet             |
| Backbone    | ResNet50         |
| Image size  | 256 × 256        |
| Weight      | ImageNet         |
| Optimizer   | Adam             |
| Loss        | bce_jaccard_loss |
| Metrics     | iou_score        |
| Epochs      | 80               |
| Random seed | 42               |
| Batch size  | 16               |

**FIGURE 3** Controller Recurrent Neural Network in NASNet framework [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](http://wileyonlinelibrary.com)]

reinforced evolutionary approach could be applied to choosing the best elements. A tournament selection approach is employed to reduce the poor performing cell. The fitness function of the child is improved and reinforcement mutations are accomplished. Through this activity, the performance of cell structure optimizes further.

The NASNet network is trained using two kinds of input images having size  $224 \times 224$  and  $331 \times 331$ , to achieve NASNet Mobile and NASNetLarge networks, respectively, presented in Table 3. Shifting from NASNetMobile to NASNetLarge requires a massive expansion in the number of parameters. Because NASNetLarge consist of 8,89,49,818 parameters and NASNetMobile comprises of 53,26,716 parameters. This creates NASNetMobile more consistent. In NASNet network, the smallest unit blocks, which are combined to create a cell as illustrated in Figure 4.

A cell is developed by concatenating various blocks, as presented in Figure 5. NASNet used a search space by factorizing the architecture into cells and further splitting it into blocks. The blocks and cells are flexible in type or number and are optimized for the specified database. More Detail about NASNet architecture can be found in (Liaqat et al., 2020; Mashood Nasir et al., 2020; Radhika et al., 2020).

The most vital accomplishments of CNNs are transfer learning that is employed where a smaller amount of data set is available such as the situation under study. In this research work, we have employed NASNet architecture for feature extraction and used ResNet50,

**TABLE 3** The NASNet architecture

|                                       |                                       |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Identity                              | $1 \times 3$ then $3 \times 1$ conv   |
| $1 \times 7$ then $7 \times 1$ conv   | $3 \times 3$ dilated conv             |
| $3 \times 3$ average pooling          | $3 \times 3$ max pooling              |
| $5 \times 5$ max pooling              | $7 \times 7$ max pooling              |
| $1 \times 1$ conv                     | $3 \times 3$ conv                     |
| $3 \times 3$ depthwise-separable—conv | $5 \times 5$ depthwise-separable—conv |
| $7 \times 7$ depthwise-separable—conv |                                       |

DenseNet201, MobileNet V2, and InceptionV3 to compare the results of NASNet with other used models. The significant features are extracted through two developments of transfer learning such as freeze layers and fine-tune. It means that the pre-trained architecture weights are transfer from source to target database, such as from ImageNet to Figshare in our case as illustrated in Figure 6. Fine-tuning of transfer learning is employed to enhance CNN architecture's efficacy and substitute the pre-trained model's final layers only. In simple words, 1,000 categories of ImageNet are substituted with the three kinds of brain tumor according to Figshare data set. In the proposed model, Adam optimizer is trained in each network, including NASNet and others for brain tumor classification. The batch size is set to 32 and  $1e-4$  is assigned to the initial learn rate with the maximum epochs of 50 as presented in Table 4

### 3.5 | Data augmentation

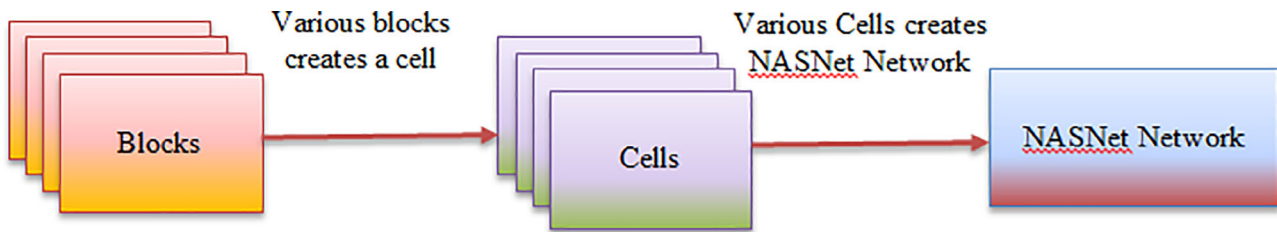
For training purposes, deep learning approaches need vast volumes of labeled data. Unfortunately, the labeled medical image data set is not large enough, causing problems during training, especially utilizing deep learning methods (Nazir, Khan, Saba, & Rehman, 2019; Perveen et al., 2020; Saba, 2020). However, the data augmentation approach provides a remedy to this issue by increasing the size of the training data accessible. Therefore, the augmentation process is employed to achieve better results on a small data set. Various data augmentation styles, such as flipping and rotation, are applied to capable the architecture to learn the variations during training. The following parameters are employed during the augmentation process, as depicted in Table 5. Moreover, some sample images are illustrated in Figure 7.

### 3.6 | Pseudo codes for detection and classification

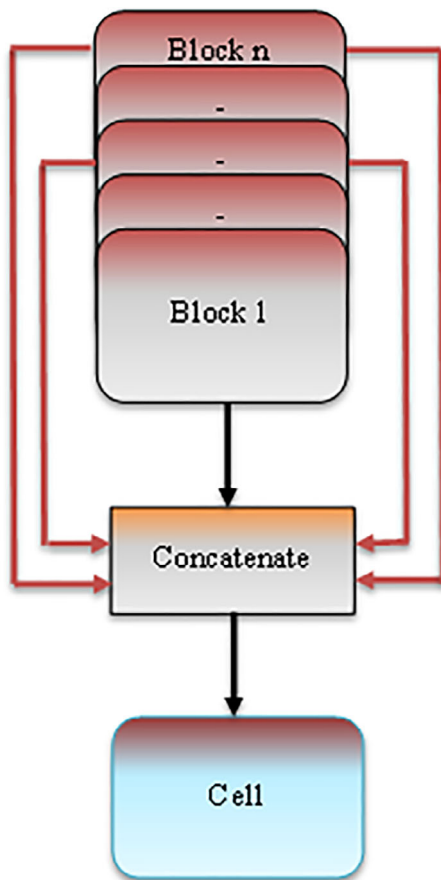
The pseudo codes for brain tumor detection and classification are presented as under.

1. procedure detection\_type (brain tumor detection)





**FIGURE 4** Creation of a cell in NASNet network [Color figure can be viewed at wileyonlinelibrary.com]



**FIGURE 5** Arrangement of NASNet [Color figure can be viewed at wileyonlinelibrary.com]

- a. Input = Figshare\_data set (3 types)
- b. Unet\_ResNet50 = detection (Input)

return detection\_type, IoU score

2. procedure classification (Figshare\_data set, true class)
  - a. Model = training ((NASNet (Figshare\_data set, trueclass, ImageNet))
  - b. Predicted\_type = testing (Model (Figshare\_data set)
  - c. Accuracy, Kappa = (Predicted\_type, trueclass)

return Predicted\_type, Accuracy, Kappa, Confusion Matrix, ROC curve.

## 4 | PERFORMANCE MEASURE OF DETECTION AND CLASSIFICATION

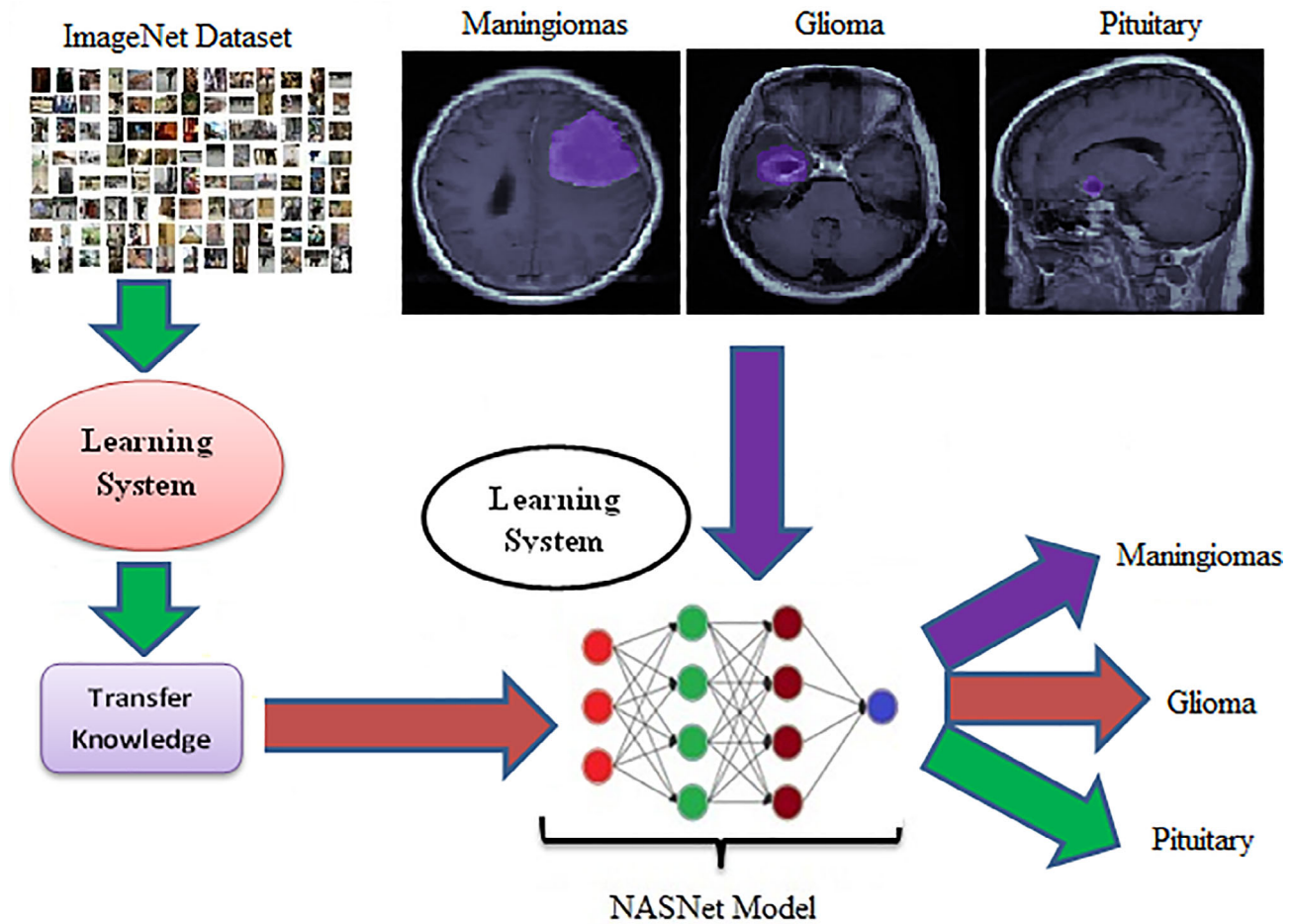
The detection of tumors is evaluated through IoU to assess brain tumor detection accuracy on a Figshare data set. Similarly, the classification of networks' performance is evaluated through accuracy and Kappa statistic ( $\kappa$ ) as recorded in Table 6. Kappa statistic ( $\kappa$ ) is a measure of information employed to compares an observed accuracy with a predictable accuracy (Viera & Garrett, 2005). For further evaluation, the ROC curve and confusion matrix of the actual and predicted tumor class is calculated during the testing phase.

Where, True positive (TP), false positive (FP), true negative (TN), and false negative (FN) are concerned to show how much the applied model correctly and wrongly classified glioma, pituitary and meningioma tumors. Furthermore,  $t_0$  is the relative experimental understanding between the ground truth and classification algorithm. The speculative probability of agreement chance by using comparative information to highlight the possibilities of every category.

## 5 | EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS

The experiments are carried on Google Colab services and performed based on the holdout method. We have assessed the best available brain tumor detection parameters using ResNet50-UNet architecture and achieved the highest IoU score of 0.9504 as presented in Figure 8. Furthermore, the actual and predicted mask is presented in Figure 9. We split the data set into two portions: training data involves 80% and testing data comprises 20% of the data set. We have evaluated the best parameters to get the highest performance of the architecture. The NASNet architecture generates the highest accuracy of 99.6% as compared to others. This value signifies the efficacy of NASNet architecture for feature extraction and classification of detected brain tumors. Similarly, the high value of kappa statistic of 0.99 for the NASNet network determines an ideal agreement with the ground truth, as presented in Table 7. Figure 10 indicates the confusion matrix acquired through the NASNet model for brain tumors classification.

The statistical validation of NASNet architecture is done through ROC analysis. Figure 11 presents the parameters for NASNet model with the resulting AUC value.



**FIGURE 6** Proposed model [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](http://wileyonlinelibrary.com)]

**TABLE 4** Hyper-parameter for classification

| Hyper-parameters      | Value                    | Size of input image |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|
| Optimizer             | Adam                     | 224 × 224           |
| Loss                  | Categorical crossentropy |                     |
| Batch size            | 32                       |                     |
| Pooling               | GlobalAveragePooling2D   |                     |
| Initial learning rate | 1e-4                     |                     |
| Epoch                 | 50                       |                     |
| Dropout               | 0.5                      |                     |
| Train size            | 0.8                      |                     |
| Test size             | 0.2                      |                     |
| Random state          | 11                       |                     |

In Figure 12, we investigated the NASNet network's performance with DenseNet20, ResNet50, Inception V3, and MobileNet V2. We have noticed that NASNet model achieve high accuracy in term of classification.

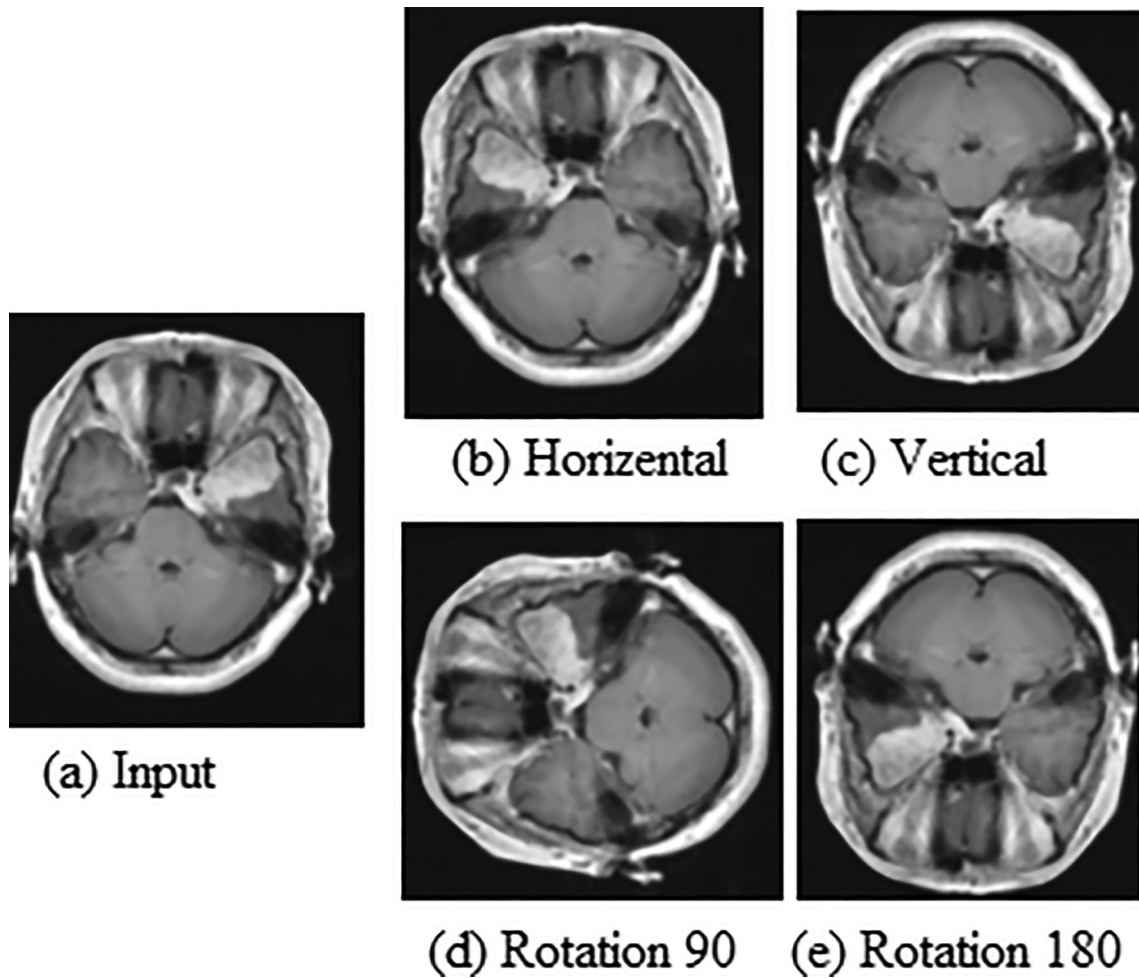
**TABLE 5** Data augmentation parameters

| Parameters      | Value   |
|-----------------|---------|
| Horizontal flip | True    |
| Vertical flip   | True    |
| Rotation range  | 90, 180 |

## 5.1 | Analysis and comparisons

Nonetheless, it is hard to compare the results with the techniques reported in state of the art due to different CNN models and data set employed (Khan, Jabeen, et al., 2020). However, we still compare current techniques on brain tumor detection and classification. Sajjad et al. (2019), after comprehensive data augmentation, fed tumor region to pre-trained VGG-19 CNN, which was fine-tuned for brain tumor grade classification and attained an accuracy of 90.67% with augmentation and without augmentation 87.38% on the radiopaedia data set.

For the classification of multimodal automatic brain tumors with linear contrast stretching, the transformation of learning-based



**FIGURE 7** Data augmentation illustration

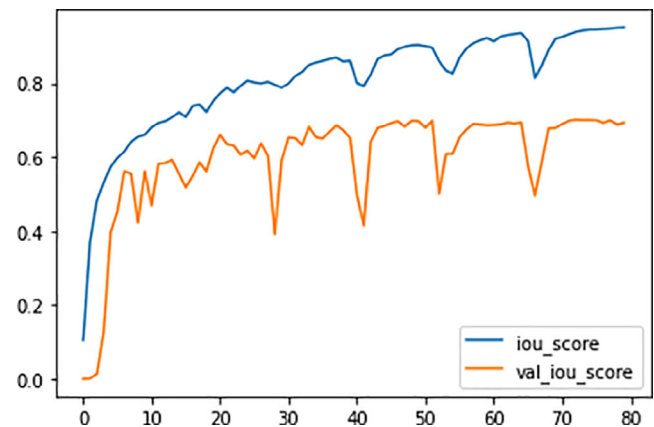
**TABLE 6** Performance metrics

| Measure            | Formula                                       |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Accuracy           | $\frac{(TP + TN)}{\{(TP + FN) + (FP + TN)\}}$ |
| Kappa ( $\kappa$ ) | $\frac{t_0 - t_e}{1 - t_e}$                   |

extraction functions, correntropy-based features set, Khan, Jabeen, et al. (2020) proposed a fusion of pre-trained CNN models (VGG16–VGG19). The fused matrix was eventually fed to the extreme learning machine for brain tumor identification. The suggested technique obtained an accuracy of 97.8, 96.9, and 92.5%, respectively, for BraTs2015, BraTs2017, and BraTs2018.

Recently, a 3D CNN architecture was developed by Rehman, Khan, Saba, et al. (2021) to identify brain tumors using a pre-trained CNN model and recorded an accuracy of 98.32, 96.97, and 92.67% in BraTs2015, BraTs2017, and BraTs2018.

Table 7 exhibits experimental results using different deep learning models to classify the brain tumor following its detection.

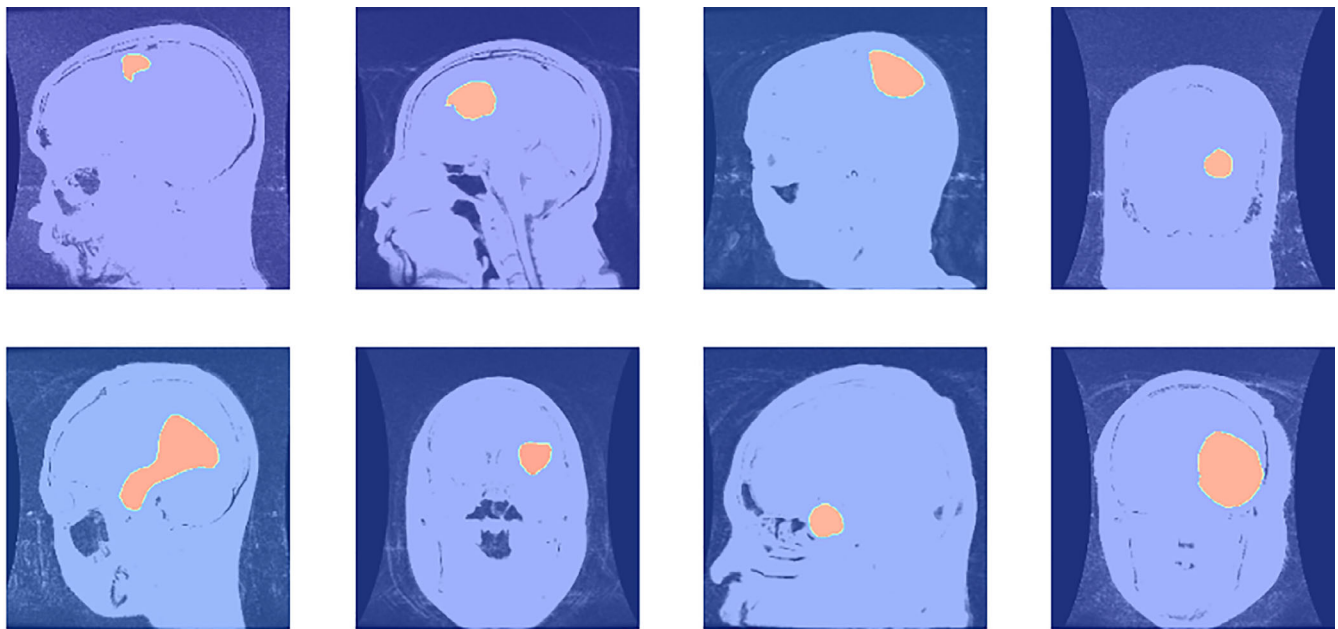


**FIGURE 8** Analysis of tumor detection [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](http://wileyonlinelibrary.com)]

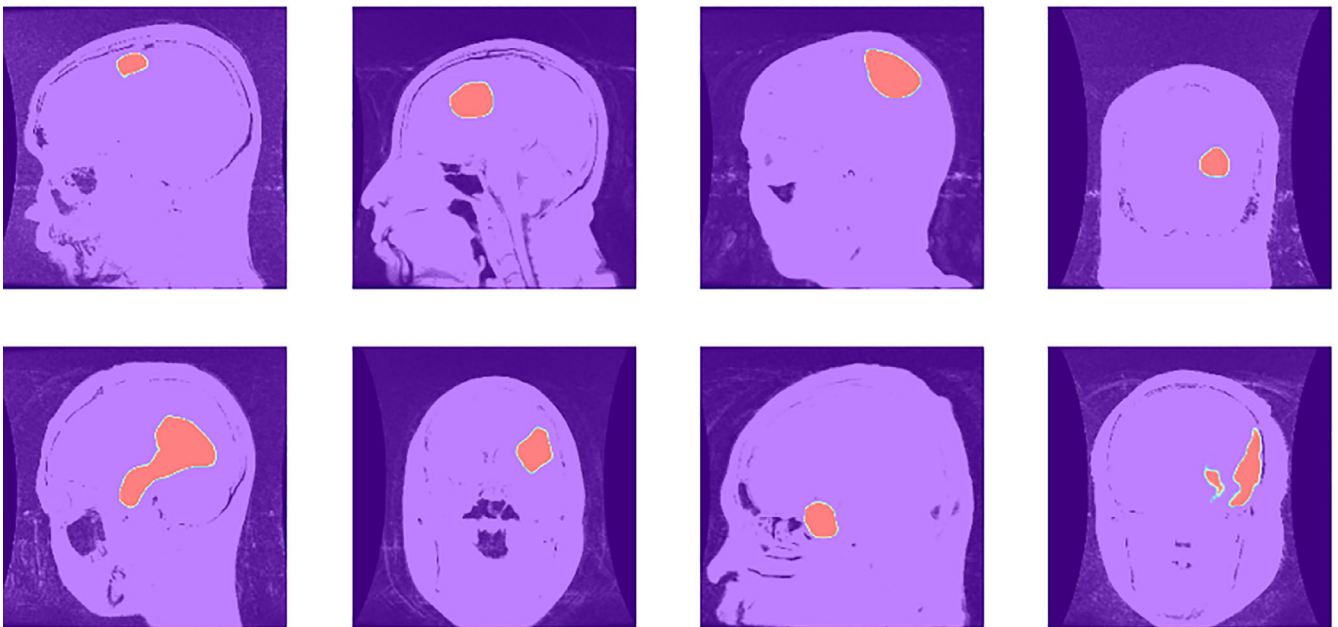
## 6 | CONCLUSION

To explore and evaluate employed networks' performance, two transfer learning processes that are freeze and fine-tune, are performed in





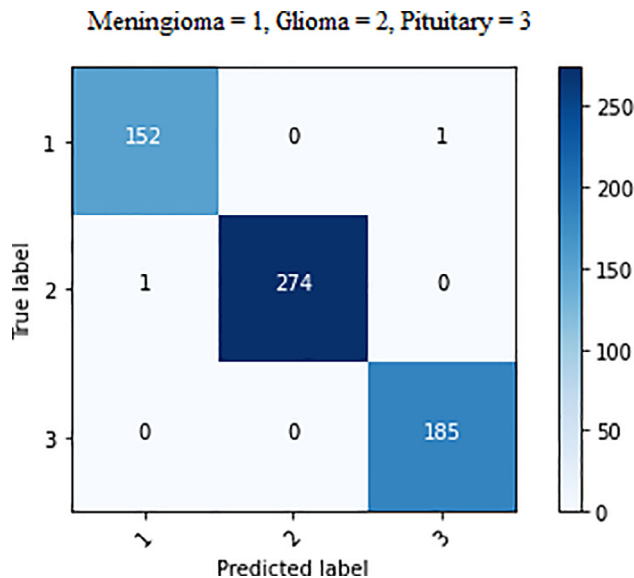
(a) Actual



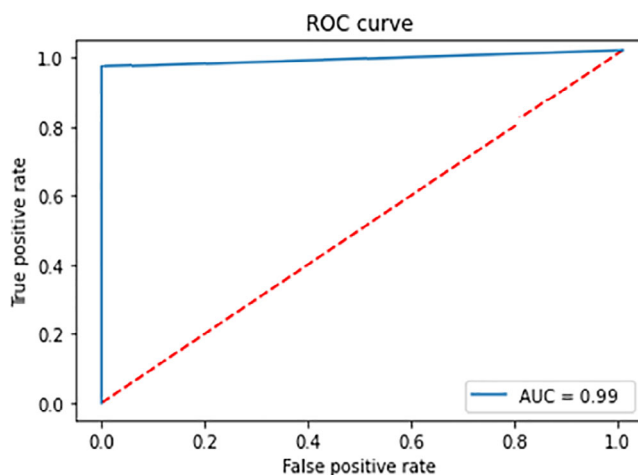
(b) Predicted

**FIGURE 9** Actual versus predicted mask [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](http://wileyonlinelibrary.com)]**TABLE 7** Experimental result

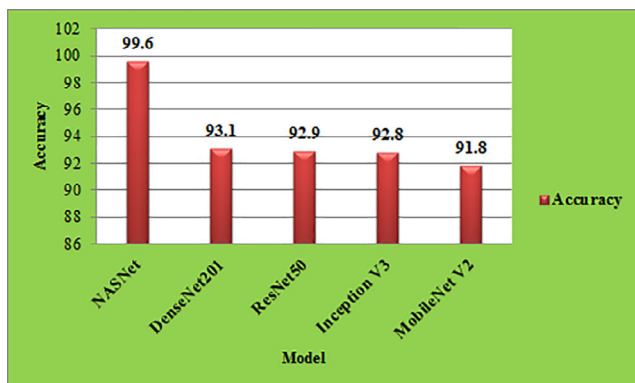
| Task                                                       | Models       | Accuracy | Kappa statistics |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|------------------|
| Classification of glioma, pituitary, and meningioma tumors | NASNet       | 98.6     | 0.99             |
|                                                            | DenseNet201  | 93.1     | 0.89             |
|                                                            | ResNet50     | 92.9     | 0.89             |
|                                                            | Inception V3 | 92.8     | 0.88             |
|                                                            | MobileNet V2 | 91.8     | 0.87             |



**FIGURE 10** Confusion matrix of classification [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](https://onlinelibrary.com)]



**FIGURE 11** ROC curve of classification [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](https://onlinelibrary.com)]



**FIGURE 12** Performance analysis of classification [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](https://onlinelibrary.com)]

this article to extract significant features from MRI slices. A well-known segmentation technique such as Unet architecture with ResNet50 as a backbone to expose the tumor part and achieved 0.9504 of IoU score. Furthermore, multi-classification of brain tumor has been performed on Figshare data set to identify the tumor type. The process of multi-classification is performed using transfer learning and NASNet architecture. To show the efficacy of NASNet architecture compared with other architectures like ResNet50, DenseNet201, MobileNet V2, Inception V3 are executed. NASNet architecture achieved a higher classification accuracy of 99.6% on the target data set.

Although this research investigated various architectures of deep CNN with transfer learning for brain tumor detection, more models still need to be researched. Therefore, powerful architecture with less computational complexity will be employed in the future.

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## CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Authors declare that they have no conflict of interest and contribute scientifically equally to deserve authorship.

## DATA AVAILABILITY STATEMENT

The data that support the findings of this study are openly available in [Figshare] at [<https://figshare.com/>], reference number [Brain tumor dataset]

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